Alexander Dao

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Computer Science and Linguistics candidate at UC Santa Cruz building Python backend pipelines and production AI tooling. Built REST APIs and JSON data pipelines in Python, and adapted and deployed a Claude-based AI agent across four Stanford course sections, reaching several hundred users in production.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz Santa Cruz, CA

Computer Science Minor, Linguistics B.A. *Expected Graduation: Winter 2027*

Relevant Coursework: Machine Learning, Data Structures and Algorithms, Mathematical Thinking for CS, Computer Networks, Database Systems

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer Intern Jul 2026 – Sep 2026

treemarks.ai *Stanford, CA*

- Built and shipped core features for a Claude-based grading agent supporting real-time grading operations, Gradescope/Canvas API access to course materials, and detailed agent feedback,
- Incorporated test gates in the MVP that checked for sufficient input documents and generated format-friendly guidelines, plus formatting-fidelity checks against manually annotated feedback from prior runs.

Intern Contributor, Tech Beat Dec 2025 – May 2026

The American Prospect *Santa Cruz, CA*

- Authored a published article on the impact of AI on entry-level job opportunities; conducted technical research, fact-checking, and data analysis on emerging AI technologies.

Content Analytics Intern Jun 2024 – Jan 2025

Paystand *Santa Cruz, CA*

- Responsible for the company YouTube channel and engagement metrics; grew subscribers from 100 to 10,000 in 3 months.

PROJECTS

Don't Die Oct 2026 – Present

Developer

- Developing a Roblox-based version of Far Cry 5; completed the first map.

NGramLM Aug 2026 – Sep 2026

Personal Project

- Built an N-gram language model in Python that ingests articles from the Wikipedia API or local corpus documents and generates context-related text output.

SpotiLytics Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

Data Engineer

- Built a REST API and JSON data pipeline using Python (Flask and SpotiPy) to collect Spotify listening data; investigating whether listening behavior varies by day of the week.

ACTIVITIES & LEADERSHIP

Math, Engineering & Science Achievement Program (MESA) Feb 2025 – Present

Member

- Built strong relationships with leaders of a STEM program supporting underrepresented first-generation college students.

Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE) Sep 2025 – Jun 2026

Former Member

- Professional engineering society for students from Hispanic backgrounds, affiliated with NSBE and MESA chapters.

SKILLS

Data & Tools: REST APIs, JSON pipelines, Flask, SpotiPy

Programming Languages: Python, C, PostgreSQL

Research: Language Models, Psycholinguistics, Neurolinguistics

Languages: English, Vietnamese, Japanese